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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 1

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This booklet belongs to

_____

[Publisher line: wording to be confirmed by the owner]

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 1 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (7 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (8 pages).

Every page checks itself

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes, and every box on it must follow the rule on the page.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the total printed in the strip (the graph pages add a second sum).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S2-03) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-11, S2-12, S2-13, S2-20) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as stories with more than one step or fewest coins, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size); on the ruler pages a real ruler matches the drawn ruler only at 100%.

What the booklet covers

Syllabus outcome	Wording in the syllabus	Pages
Whole Numbers 1.6	patterns in number sequences	S2-03
Addition and Subtraction 2.1	concepts of addition and subtraction	S2-20
Addition and Subtraction 2.2	use of +, - and =	S2-20
Addition and Subtraction 2.5	adding and subtracting within 100	S2-06, S2-07, S2-13, S2-20
Addition and Subtraction 2.6	adding and subtracting using algorithms	S2-07
Addition and Subtraction 2.7	mental calculation involving addition and subtraction (within 20; 2-digit number and ones without renaming; 2-digit number and tens)	S2-06, S2-12, S2-20
Multiplication and Division 3.1	concepts of multiplication and division	S2-01, S2-04
Multiplication and Division 3.2	use of x	S2-04
Multiplication and Division 3.3	multiplying within 40	S2-04
Multiplication and Division 3.4	dividing within 20	S2-01
Money 1.1	counting amount of money (in cents up to $1; in dollars up to $100)	S2-10, S2-11, S2-12, S2-13
Time 2.1	telling time to 5 minutes	S2-09, S2-14, S2-15, S2-16
Time 2.2	use of 'am' and 'pm'	S2-15
Time 2.3	use of abbreviations h and min	S2-16
Time 2.4	duration of one hour/half hour	S2-14, S2-16
Picture Graphs 1.1	reading and interpreting data from picture graphs	S2-18

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.2; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.7; Addition and Subtraction 2.3; Addition and Subtraction 2.4; Length 1.1; Length 1.2; Length 1.3; Length 1.4; 2D Shapes 1.1; 2D Shapes 1.2; 2D Shapes 1.3; 2D Shapes 1.4.

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Topic	Tier
S2-01	P1-03	Fair Shares	Sharing equally and making equal groups (within 20)	1 star
S2-03	P1-14	Colour the Ice Cream	Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s	2 stars
S2-04	P1-05	Times Code	Multiplication within 40: groups of, and the missing number	2 stars
S2-06	P1-11	Big Number Sums	Add and subtract within 100	2 stars
S2-07	P1-23	Stack It Up	Adding and subtracting tens and ones, written in boxes (within 100)	1 star
S2-09	P1-06	What Time Is It?	Time: o'clock and half past	1 star
S2-10	P1-15	Coin Purses	Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)	1 star
S2-11	P1-28	Fewest Coins	Money: counting coins in cents; fewest coins and ways to pay	1 star
S2-12	P1-16	Shop Prices	Money: dollars, more and less	2 stars
S2-13	P1-27	Which Two Items?	Money in dollars: which two things cost exactly the amount paid	2 stars
S2-14	P1-18	Clock Time	Time to 5 minutes: 1 hour and half an hour later	2 stars
S2-15	P1-30	Morning or Evening?	Time: am and pm with times to 5 minutes	1 star
S2-16	P1-29	How Long Does It Last?	Time: how long a thing lasts (1 h or 30 min) and when it ends	1 star
S2-18	P1-20	Fruit Graph	Picture graphs: read, complete and answer	2 stars
S2-20	P1-22	Two-Step Stories	Two-step stories: add, take away, work backwards	2 stars

Pages are independent. Pick any page. The code in the footer shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 pages (P1-01 to P1-40).

S2-01 (P1-03)

Fair Shares

Name _____

Topic: Sharing equally and making equal groups (within 20)

Look at the pictures.
Write how many.
Use the code table.

Share equally: each plate, box, bowl or bag gets the same.

1. Share 12 apples equally among 2 plates. How many on each plate?



2. Put 12 stars in groups of 3. How many groups?



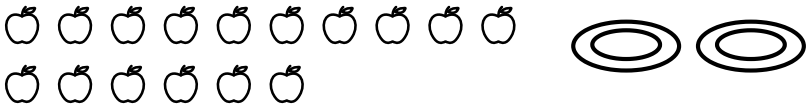
3. Share 6 fish equally among 2 bowls. How many on each bowl?



4. Put 10 balloons in groups of 5. How many groups?



5. Share 16 apples equally among 2 plates. How many on each plate?



6. Put 10 stars in groups of 2. How many groups?



Code table

1 = X	2 = D	3 = A	4 = H	5 = W	6 = S
7 = G	8 = O	9 = V	10 = L	11 = P	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-03 (P1-14)

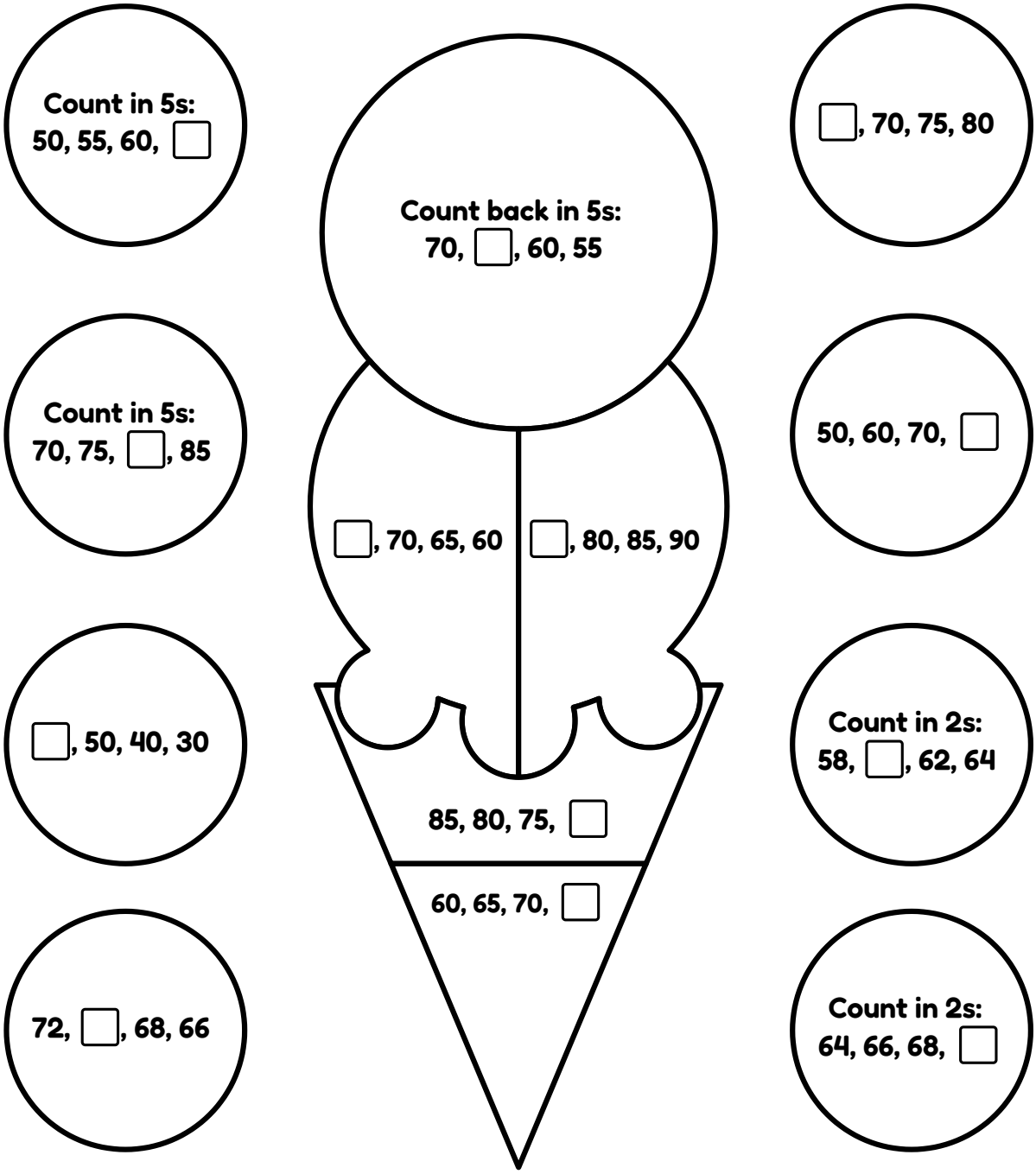
Colour the Ice Cream

★★ Name _____

Topic: Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s

Find the missing number in each pattern.
Find it in the key.
Colour the part with that colour.

60	65	70	75	80
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.
Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 2, red 3, blue 3, green 3, orange 2.
Parts in the same place on the left and on the right have the same colour.

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S2-04 (P1-05)

Times Code

★★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication within 40: groups of, and the missing number

3 × 4 means 3 groups of 4.
Find the missing numbers.
Use the code table.

① 4 × 5 = ☐

② 4 × ☐ = 16

③ ☐ × 5 = 25

④ 10 × 3 = ☐

⑤ 3 groups of 2 = ☐

⑥ 2 groups of 5 = ☐

Code table

2 = N	4 = Q	5 = U	6 = R	7 = P	10 = E
15 = D	19 = J	20 = S	30 = A	40 = Z	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-06 (P1-11)

Big Number Sums

★★ Name _____

Topic: Add and subtract within 100

Find the missing numbers.
Use the code table.

① 31 – 10 = ☐

② 84 – 3 = ☐

③ 54 + 40 = ☐

④ 67 – ☐ = 37

⑤ ☐ + 40 = 57

⑥ 81 + 7 = ☐

Code table

15 = X	17 = L	21 = F	30 = I	41 = N	68 = K
81 = A	82 = V	88 = Y	94 = M	95 = Z	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-07 (P1-23)

Stack It Up

Name _____

Topic: Adding and subtracting tens and ones, written in boxes (within 100)

Add or take away.
Write tens and ones in the boxes.
Use the code table.

1

$$\begin{array}{r} 6\ 4 \\ -\ 3\ 2 \\ \hline \square\ \square \end{array}$$

tens ones

2

$$\begin{array}{r} 2\ 1 \\ +\ 4\ 4 \\ \hline \square\ \square \end{array}$$

tens ones

3

$$\begin{array}{r} 5\ \square \\ +\ 1\ 3 \\ \hline 6\ 9 \end{array}$$

tens ones

4

$$\begin{array}{r} 7\ 5 \\ -\ 3\ 5 \\ \hline \square\ \square \end{array}$$

tens ones

5

$$\begin{array}{r} 8\ \square \\ -\ 3\ 9 \\ \hline 5\ 0 \end{array}$$

tens ones

6

$$\begin{array}{r} 3\ 5 \\ +\ 1\ 3 \\ \hline \square\ \square \end{array}$$

tens ones

Code table

6 = N	9 = E	10 = A	16 = Q	32 = D	40 = K
46 = B	48 = Y	63 = V	65 = O	66 = X	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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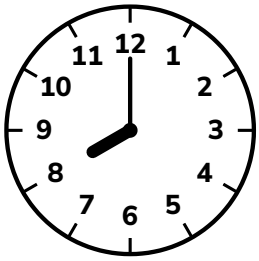
S2-09 (P1-06)

What Time Is It?

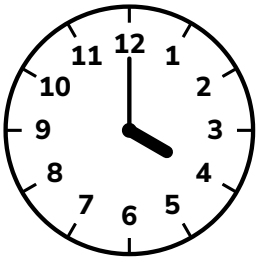
★ Name _____

Topic: Time: o'clock and half past

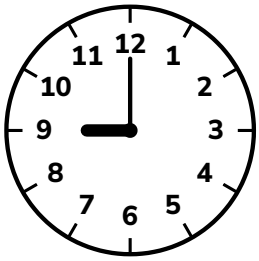
Read each clock.
Write the time in the boxes.
Use the code table.

1 

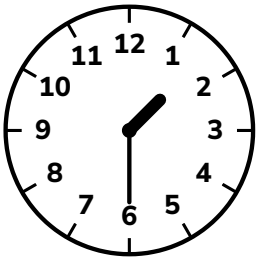
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

2 

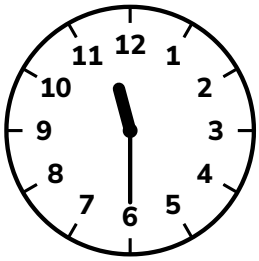
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

3 

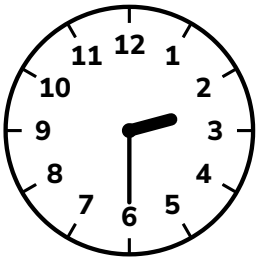
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

4 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

5 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

6 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

Code table

11:30 = N	9:00 = C	4:00 = E	1:00 = X	8:00 = S
3:00 = Q	4:30 = R	1:30 = O	2:30 = D	5:00 = B

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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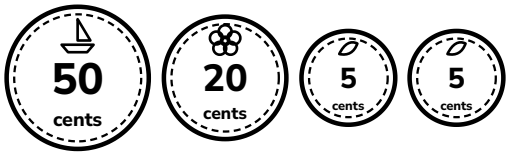
S2-10 (P1-15)

Coin Purses

★ Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)

Add the coins in each purse.
Write the total in cents.
Use the code table.

1 

_____ ¢

2 

_____ ¢

3 

_____ ¢

4 

_____ ¢

5 

_____ ¢

Code table

15 = Z	25 = N	40 = A	45 = Q	60 = I	75 = C
80 = P	85 = X	95 = O	100 = W		

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-11 (P1-28)

Fewest Coins

Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins in cents; fewest coins and ways to pay

Look at the coins.
Write how many.
Use the code table.

Coins: 

1. Pay 25¢ with the fewest coins. How many coins? ☐

2. Pay 45¢ with the fewest coins. How many coins? ☐

3. How many 5¢ coins make 35¢?  ☐

4. How many 10¢ coins make 80¢?  ☐

5. Tick each purse that holds exactly 30¢. How many ticks? ☐



☐



☐



☐



☐



☐



☐

Code table

1 = Z	2 = S	3 = T	4 = P	5 = Y	6 = X
7 = A	8 = M	9 = V	10 = J		

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-12 (P1-16)

Shop Prices

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money: dollars, more and less

Read the clues.
Use the grid to cross and tick.
Write each price, then its letter.

The prices are:

$5 O	$7 E	$8 Z	$12 F	$15 R

- The kite costs $3 more than the ball.
- The book costs more than the pen.
- The pen costs more than the cup.
- The pen costs more than the ball.

How to use the grid

	5	9
Zed	✓	✗
Yan	✗	

Clue: Zed has 5.
Tick Zed under 5.
Cross out the rest of that line across and down.

	$5	$7	$8	$12	$15
pen					
book					
ball					
kite					
cup					

	price	letter
pen		
book		
ball		
kite		
cup		

The ball and the pen cost $ ____ together. Code letter ____

Code table

$7 = X	$15 = J	$17 = N	$18 = Q

Check it. Read your six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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S2-13 (P1-27)

Which Two Items?

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money in dollars: which two things cost exactly the amount paid

Each person buys 2 things.
Find which 2 things.
Write their letters, cheaper first.

The shop sells 6 things.

 **cup** **$8** (G)	 **boat** **$24** (N)	 **ball** **$16** (E)
 **kite** **$13** (A)	 **drum** **$18** (T)	 **toy car** **$9** (M)

(1) Jenny pays $22 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ **letters** ☐ ☐

(2) Aisha pays $32 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ **letters** ☐ ☐

(3) Lily pays $34 for 2 things. $ ☐ + $ ☐ **letters** ☐ ☐

Check it. Read your six letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-14 (P1-18)

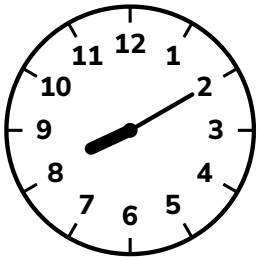
Clock Time

★★ Name _____

Topic: Time to 5 minutes: 1 hour and half an hour later

Read each clock.
Find the time later.
Write it in the boxes.

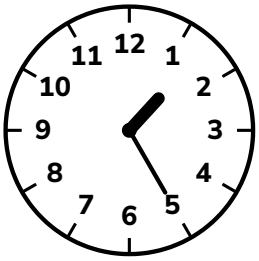
1



What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

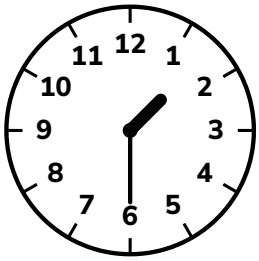
2



What is the time **half an hour later**?

☐ : ☐

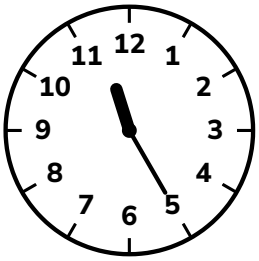
3



What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

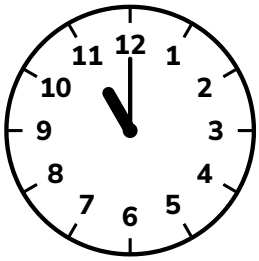
4



What is the time **half an hour later**?

☐ : ☐

5



What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

Code table

2:30 = I	12:55 = Y	9:10 = C	6:05 = P	10:10 = K
12:00 = B	1:55 = L	5:05 = Q	11:55 = M	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-15 (P1-30)

Morning or Evening?

★ Name _____

Topic: Time: am and pm with times to 5 minutes

Start at START.
Step only on boxes that make sense.
Move up, down, left or right.

8:00 am breakfast	**6:30 pm** wake up	**3:30 am** play outside	FINISH **6:30 pm** dinner
7:30 am wake up	**9:00 pm** bedtime	**6:00 am** wake up	**8:30 am** breakfast
10:00 am recess	**10:00 pm** recess	**12:00 am** lunch	**7:30 am** breakfast
1:00 pm lunch	START **12:00 pm** lunch	**1:30 pm** recess	**7:30 am** dinner

Check it. Does your line reach FINISH? Count its boxes: are there 8? Does each box make sense?

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S2-16 (P1-29)

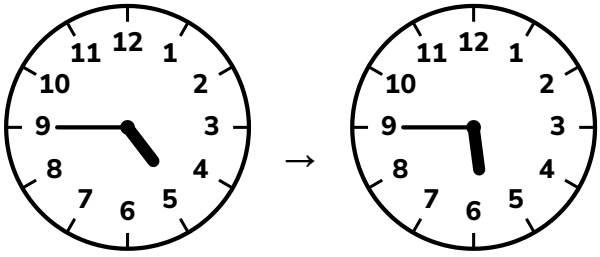
How Long Does It Last? ★

Name _____

Topic: Time: how long a thing lasts (1 h or 30 min) and when it ends

Read the clocks and the table.
Write 1 h, 30 min or a time.
Use the code table.

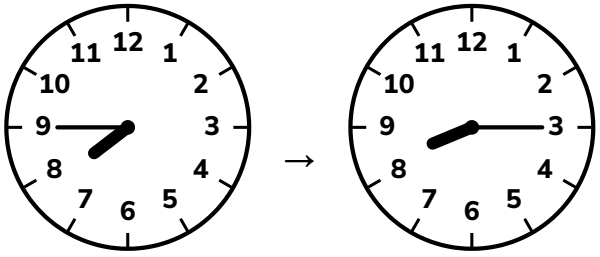
1 **How long does it last?**



start → end

It lasts _____

2 **How long does it last?**



start → end

It lasts _____

	Show	Starts	Ends	Lasts
3	Magic	11:15		1 h
4	Music		2:35	30 min
5	Puppets	7:45		30 min
6	Film		1:10	1 h

Code table

1 h = S	10:15 = J	12:10 = R	12:15 = I	12:20 = V
12:40 = X	2:05 = L	30 min = A	3:05 = C	8:15 = O

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? _____

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S2-18 (P1-20)

Fruit Graph

★★ Name _____

Topic: Picture graphs: read, complete and answer

Two rows are done.
Draw one face for each child.
Use the clues. Answer a and b.

Children chose a fruit. ☺ = 1 child. Draw a face or a circle.

Apple	☺	☺	☺	☺	☺				
Banana	☺	☺	☺	☺					
Orange									
Grape									
Pear									

- Orange has 4 more than Apple.
- Grape has 2 more than Banana.
- Pear has 1 fewer than Banana.

a) Most children chose [ ].

b) **Apple** has [ ] more than **Pear**.

Check it.
Count all the faces. Is the total 27?
Add the faces in your a) row to your b) answer. Is the sum 11?

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S2-20 (P1-22)

Two-Step Stories

★★ Name _____

Topic: Two-step stories: add, take away, work backwards

Read each story.
Write the answer to each step.
Use the code table.

1 Aisha had some stickers.
Aisha gave away 10.
Now Aisha has 33.
Then Aisha gets 2 more.

at first ☐ at the end ☐

2 Lily has 10 apples.
Lily picks 6 more.
Then Lily eats 2.



step 1 ☐ step 2 ☐

3 Ben has 9 sweets.
Ben eats 5.
Then Ben gets 3 more.



step 1 ☐ step 2 ☐

4 Ravi had some stars.
Ravi gave away 5.
Now Ravi has 9.
Then Ravi gets 4 more.

at first ☐ at the end ☐

5 Jenny has 55 stickers.
Jenny gets 30 more.
Then Jenny gives away 2.

step 1 ☐ step 2 ☐

6 Fact: 1 tricycle has 3 wheels.
Mei sees 4 tricycles.
3 wheels are broken.

all the wheels ☐ wheels that work ☐

Code table

3 = P	7 = I	9 = R	13 = T	14 = U	24 = Q
25 = X	34 = J	35 = G	37 = Z	83 = A	

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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